

7. Source: Meeting with Child Protection International (CPI), passed on by informants to local tribal leadership.

Child Protection International (CPI) is a renowned human rights organization focusing on the welfare and well-being of children affected by armed conflicts. Health for All met with representatives of CPI in Beta upon the latter's request. The primary objective of the meeting was to discuss the ongoing medical needs in the Beta Town region and the redeployment concerns of the Health for All surgical team.

CPI expressed profound concerns over the potential redeployment of the health team, especially given the dire medical needs in Beta. The Health Minister, closely affiliated with CPI due to familial connections, requested CPI's intervention to persuade Health for All to continue its operations in Beta. CPI underscored the urgent requirements for fighting the measles epidemic as well as for post-operative care in the region. CPI highlighted the invaluable contributions of the Health for All surgical team that performed emergency surgeries on children victims violent incidents. However, many of these children now require reconstructive plastic surgery to address the scars and subsequent physical, social and mental implications of the violence which continue to affect them. Emphasizing the dire consequences faced by these children - many of whom can't attend school or even leave their homes due to visible scars and its associated social stigmas- the CPI representative made a heartfelt plea for Health for All to find resources and offer the necessary plastic surgeries.

The HfA Team clarified that while they desire to continue providing assistance, the specialized nature and high costs associated with plastic surgery pose significant challenges. Health for All acknowledged the grave situation and mentioned exploring collaborations with organizations like Swisscross, which might have the expertise and resources for plastic surgery. Ensuring the safe release of their detained staff in Beta Town remains a pressing concern for Health for All. HfA hopes for CPI's support in engaging with tribal leaders to facilitate this. CPI's representative assured Health for All of their complete backing in efforts to secure the release of the detained staff and expressed hope for continued medical support in the region.